

Success, succeed, successful, successfully

Learner workbook

Use the correct member of a word family.

Understand the distinction

Success is a noun: The event was a success. Succeed is a verb: We succeeded. Successful is an adjective: The event was successful. Successfully is an adverb: We completed it successfully.

Use succeed in + -ing for achieving an action: succeed in finding a solution. Not every noun use needs an article: hard work can contribute to success. Describe what the success means instead of relying only on a positive label.

Compare the patterns

NOUN

The event was a success.

A success names a successful event.

VERB

We succeeded in finding a room.

In is followed by an -ing form.

ADVERB

We booked the room successfully.

Successfully modifies booked.

Read each example. Explain what the highlighted choice means in context. Then cover the example and say a similar sentence.

Check your understanding

Write before looking at the answers. The guide gives a model answer and explains the choice. Other wording can be correct.

1. Complete: The project was ____ . (success / successful)

2. Complete: We succeeded in ____ the problem. (solve)

3. Choose the adverb: success / successful / successfully

Use it in your own life

Describe an achievement using two members of this word family.

Self-check

Does your sentence express your intended meaning? Does its form follow the relevant pattern? Can a reader understand the context?

Try again

After checking the explanation, revise your sentence. Say it aloud or use it in a short conversation.

Answers and explanation

1. successful

An adjective describes the project.

2. solving

Use -ing after in.

3. successfully

The adverb can describe how an action was completed.

One possible response

We successfully organized the meeting. It was a success because everyone could join.

This is a model, not the only acceptable answer. Assess meaning, grammar, and context together.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-34.html